

organized. This will boost tourism opportunities.

MEMORIES OF MAHATMA GANDHI RELATED TO CHHATTISGARH

The Father of the Nation, Mahatma Gandhi was also not untouched by Chhattisgarh. He came here. The first arrival took place on 20 December 1920 and the second arrival on 22 November 1933.

FIRST ARRIVAL IN CHHATTISGARH

Pt. Sunderlal Sharma went to Calcutta on 2 December to pick up Gandhiji during the Kandel Village Satyagraha (1920) run in the present Dhamtari district. He took them to Raipur on 20 December 1920. He was welcomed on the platform by Pt. Ravi Shankar Shukla, Thakur Pyarelal Singh, Sakharam Dubey etc. He was accompanied by the eminent Ali brothers, Maulana Shaukat Ali.



KANDEL CANAL SATYAGRAHA

On his first arrival in Chhattisgarh, the people of Raipur welcomed Gandhi with great enthusiasm. Gandhiji's speech took place in a huge public meeting at the present Gandhi Chowk in Raipur. It was only after this public meeting addressed by Gandhiji that the place got the name Gandhi Chowk. After this meeting, this place became the center of public activities of the whole of Chhattisgarh.

Gandhiji arrived in Dhamtari on 21 December 1920. Upon his arrival, Gandhiji was welcomed with great enthusiasm by the people of the city at Makai Bandh Chowk. In Dhamtari, Gandhiji gave a speech in Mooja Hussain's enclosure. Here a businessman named Umar Seth carried Gandhiji on his shoulders and took him to the stage. The Zamindar



of the city, Bajirao Kridutt presented a bag of Rs 501 to Gandhiji, welcoming him on behalf of the town and the villagers.

After that Gandhiji addressed the public for about 1 hour, Gandhiji congratulated the people for the success of Kandel movement. The program went on till about 1 o'clock. Having lunch at Nathuji Jagtap's place, left for Raipur. Gandhiji also went to Kandel and Kurad village from Dhamtari. where he was warmly welcomed. Arrangements were made for Gandhiji's stay at Dhamtari at Shri Narayan Rao Meghawale, where he rested for the night.

During his first visit - Gandhiji addressed a gathering of women in the courtyard of Anand Samaj Library located in Raipur Brahmanpara. Women participated in large numbers in this meeting. Here women donated jewelery worth about Rs 2000 for the Tilak Swaraj Fund.

GANDHIJI'S SECOND ARRIVAL IN CHHATTISGARH

Gandhiji's second arrival in Chhattisgarh took place on 22 November 1933 in Durg district. Gandhiji was accompanied by his personal secretary Mahadev Desai, Thakkar Bapa, Miss Meera Ben (Madelaine Slade) and Jamunalal Bajaj's daughter Madalsa Narayanan also came to Raipur. In this journey, he went to places like Durg, Dhamtari, Bhatapara, Bilaspur etc.

The main reason for the arrival was the upliftment of Harijans. But on coming here, he came to know that the work of Harijan uddhar is already going on in Chhattisgarh. Which was started in 1917 by Pandit Sunderlal Sharma ji. Gandhi ji was happy to know this and he called Pandit Sunderlal Sharma ji as his guru.

ESTABLISHMENT OF RURAL INDUSTRIAL PARK ON GANDHI JAYANTI

On the occasion of Gandhi Jayanti, an action plan and work has been started to develop four rural industrial parks in each development block of Chhattisgarh. In this, the availability of raw materials at the local level will be taken care of. For example, in Dete Bijapur, Dantewada and Kondagaon districts where processing units of various minor forest produce are being set up along with Mahua, Tamarind, Tikhur. Similarly, for processing of herbal medicines in Gauthans from Korba to Surguja, Kosa work is done in Korba, Janjgir-Champa, Bastar, units of Kosa fabric are being established here. There will also be a training center in these industrial parks.